

Managing Early Childhood Care Education for National Consciousness Sustainability in Nigeria

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Article Info	Abstract
Received : 2022-03-01 Accepted : 2022-06-14 Published : 2022-06-14	The main objective of this study was to investigate the effect of management of early childhood care education on national consciousness sustainability. the participants were selected from the sampled public early childhood care education in the northeast zone, of Nigeria. sample of 331 head teachers and 351 teachers to make a total of 682 participants were proportionally selected from the sampled schools. Pearson product-moment correlation coefficient and linear regression analysis were used to test the hypotheses. The findings showed that staffing, planning of lessons, and coordination enhanced national consciousness sustainability. Thus, it was recommended that school managers should continue to provide appropriate and adequate staffing of early childhood care education so as to improve the effective development of human capital towards promoting national consciousness sustainability. Also, school managers should encourage caregivers to effectively plan lessons in order to motivate learners and build collaborative processes between teachers and school managers towards the realization of national consciousness sustainability. Furthermore, school managers should continue to coordinate early childhood care education effectively and efficiently so as to ensure mutual understanding and effective teamwork for the realization of national consciousness sustainability.
Key words: management; national consciousness; sustainability; coordination; planning	

INTRODUCTION

The success of the country education system may be said to have depend largely on a very strong foundation and that foundation is otherwise known as early childhood care education (Eyiuche & Lilian-Rita, 2013). It serves as a pillar for all other education by providing the learners with a good preparatory ground for further education.

The school as an institution is a social system designed to serve the needs of the society. The school cannot operate in a social vacuum that is different from the society which it has been designed to serve. The school derives its existence and sustenance from the community that supplies the inputs that are used in the school. The school in turn processed, mould and transform the input which it sends back as output to the community so as to develop and advanced it for the betterment of the larger society. This means that the school as a social system should serve the purposes of educating and shaping the habits, interests and feeling of the child; prepare an individual for survival and functionality in the society by providing and equipping the individual with knowledge, skills, capacities and competencies as well as transmit the societal norms, culture, traditions and values from one generation to another in order to prevent cultural Extinction (Abdullahi, 2019).

The main objectives of early childhood care education as stated in the National Policy on Education (2013) are: to develop in the entire citizenry a strong consciousness for education and country development from formal school system; Ensuring the acquisition of the appropriate level of literacy, numeracy, communicative and manipulative as well as morale, civic and ethical values needed for laying foundation.

Effective management of early childhood care education would play a vital role in making people understand the nature of diversity in Nigeria, appreciate and respect the cultural diversity and realize the need for cooperation, tolerance and unity. (Sheu & Ijaiya, 2006).

Several studies have been conducted over time on the issue of early childhood care education sustainability. Mustafa, et al (2018) investigated the effectiveness of the types of kindergarten curricula in promoting National consciousness among the Jordanian Kindergarten children. Ex-Post Facto research design was employed on a sample of 120 children. The findings revealed that modern comprehensive developmental curriculum was the most effective curriculum for promoting national consciousness. Adebola (2007) conducted his own study on the Perceived impact of Universal Basic Education on National development in Nigeria. Adesina (2011) conducted his own study on the impact of Primary Education on the attainment of Nigeria vision 2020. In this regard, 600 primary schools' teachers were selected randomly from Ojo local government area, Oyo state. Data collected were analyzed using t-test statistical tool. The finding shows that the primary education standards have impact on the nation attainment of vision 2020. Willy (2013) focused his research light on National consciousness and identity in Tanzania. Vera (2018) investigated enhancement of community development by upholding national value through Universal Basic Education curriculum. Eyiuche and Lilian-Rita (2013) treatise has a focus on functional citizenship education for sustainable development in Nigerian colleges of education in 21st century. Otwin (2008) paid attention to national service and national consciousness in Nigeria. Oguzie (2014) focused on using guidance and counselling services as a coping strategy for impacting the consciousness of peace, national security and conflict resolution. Sample of 127 counsellors were selected. Descriptive statistics was used to analyze collected data. The results shows that effective utilization of guidance and counselling services impact the spirit of consciousness in youth. There are numerous areas of principal leadership and goal achievement that are yet to be discussed by these scholars. These areas include principal administrative leadership and national consciousness sustainability in Kwara State, Nigeria. In addition, to the researcher' knowledge, there have been no research in Nigeria so far that have looked at curriculum coordination and evaluation of instruction as critical indices to measure principal administrative leadership towards national consciousness sustainability. As such, this study attempts to fill the gaps left by the previous scholars. The following objectives have been formulated to:

- Examine the relationship between staffing and national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria.
- Investigate the relationship between planning of lesson and national consciousness sustainability in North-east, Nigeria.
- Determine the relationship between coordination and national consciousness sustainability in Northeast Nigeria.
- Find out the relationship among staffing, planning, coordination and national consciousness sustainability in North-east, Nigeria.

LITERATURE REVIEW

Managing Early Childhood Care Education

Management refers to the process of planning, organizing, coordinating, directing, staffing and controlling the available human and material resources towards the attainment of stated goals and objectives Abdullahi (2019). According to Asoduke & Ikputibo (2012), Early childhood care Education serve as a steppingstone for laying the academic and morale foundation for creating the best opportunities for learners. Management of early childhood care education in this study refers an act of providing appropriate resources (staffing) and optimal utilization of these resources (planning & coordination) towards the achievement of national consciousness sustainability.

Staffing is the process of identifying and selecting the most qualified individuals for positions in an establishment or organization. It involves a careful study and analysis of the staff needed for the betterment of an organization. Staffing is the operation of having eligible employees by evaluating their knowledge, skills for specific job roles. Planning is a decision-making process concerned with the line of action to pursue to achieve pre-determined organizational goals through the maximum use of available resources. It involves a comprehensive study and analysis of alternative choices of actions that could be followed in order to achieve stated goals and objectives. Alexopoulos (2019) sees planning as the process of establishing priorities for future actions so as to solve economic problems that stems the existence of scarce resources in order to improve organization, society and even nation. Government as major manager of education system should realize that the success of the school programme and that of the overall education goals depends on the quality, dedication and performance of the staff. Effective planning of education system helps in maintaining a good control of education, help to achieve stated objectives of an organization, it encourages managers' and learners' creativity and motivation, it facilitates proper coordination of education to achieve national consciousness, and it increases the efficiency of the school system.

National consciousness sustainability

National consciousness may be defined as a way of fostering patriotism, understanding of a Nation's ideology and promoting of national identity through history, culture, ethnic, religious tolerance and loyalties. Consciousness means the quality of awareness and the ability to use one's mental sense to understand events happening in an environment at a particular period of time. consciousness can be seen as an act of transforming individuals, communities, private and public institutions through building of human capacities in order to enhance maximum utilization of available resources towards societal and economic improvements (Mustafa, et al, 2018). Sustainability refers to the improvement and maintenance of opportunities that will enable the people and societies to realize their full potential and enhancing the economic, social and environmental system for a sustained period of time (Abdullahi, 2019). This implies that sustainability is a way of retaining and satisfying the needs of the existing generation without making the coming generation worse when they are contrastingly viewed.

Good citizenship signified respect for oneself and others in accordance with the duties, rights, and privileged, of being an inhabitant of a geographical location with the process of hardworking, contentment, humility, as well as commitment to the development of the society (Akogun, et al, 2019). The duties and obligations of a good citizen include obedience to the rule, ensure effective environmental sanitation, peace, cleanliness of the environment, security of information and property of every people in the state as well as community service by participating in the development programme of the community.

Tolerance is the ability to bear with one another irrespective of differences in view of opinion, knowledge or beliefs in order to enhance meaningful progress and development. Tolerance is the willingness to accept an individual or group of people to express their view, opinions and choice in religion matters (Abdullahi, 2019). Peace and security refer to the act by which people exercise choice of safety that will bring about relatively confidence in protecting live and properties from danger (Jacob & Andrew).

The following hypotheses were formulated and tested:

1. There is a significant relationship between staffing and national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria
2. There is a significant relationship between planning and national consciousness sustainability in North-east, Nigeria.
3. There is a significant relationship between coordination and national consciousness sustainability in North-east, Nigeria.
4. There is a significant relationship between managing early childhood care education and national consciousness sustainability in North-east, Nigeria.

This study focuses on Hersey and Blanchard (1982) integrated management theory as cited in Abdullahi (2019). This theory posits that management process is a function of the leader, the subordinates and other situational variables. This theory pay attention to the forces within the leader (school heads), the subordinates (teachers/caregivers & learners) and the particular situation which includes cultural differences, custom, tradition, external environment and objectives. This theory explain that managers style must be adjusted to the subordinates and the situation or environment. Under the integrated management approach, managers must identify their prevalent style of management and carefully choose the most effective approach base on appropriate consideration of the nature of subordinates and the situation.

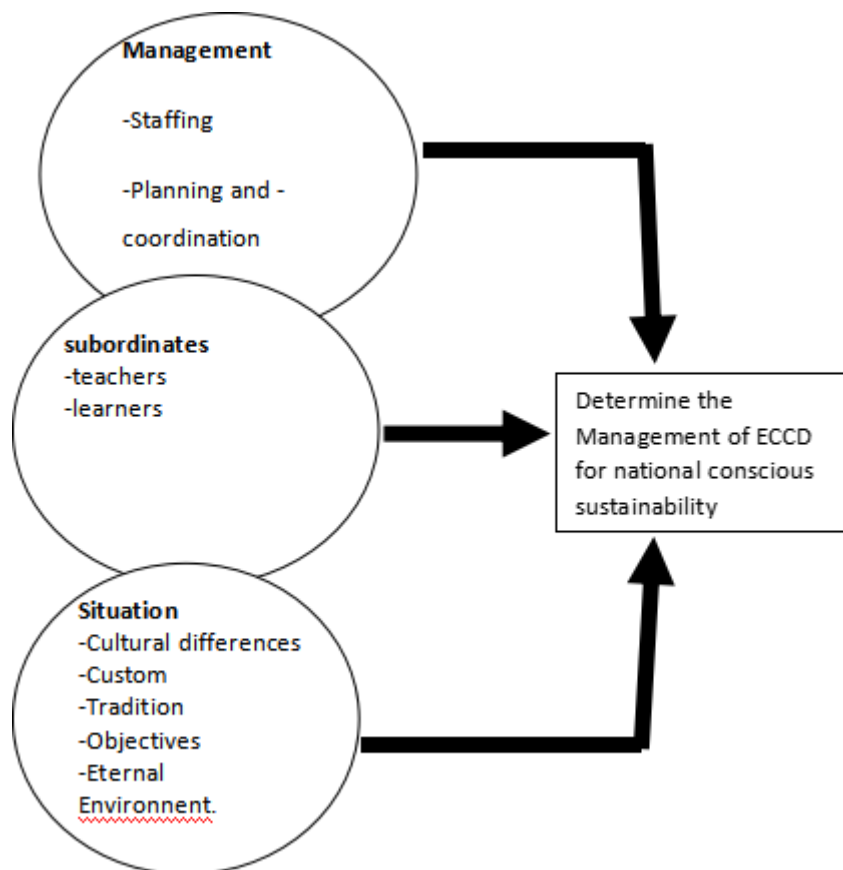


Figure 1: Integrated Leadership Approach. Source: Adapted from Hersey and Blanchard (1982, p. 77) as cited in Abdullahi (2019)

This theory can be applied in educational setting such that, school managers must understand the fact that staffing is the most important factor for consideration in the effective management of early childhood care education. In the event that teachers do not possess adequate education or skills and inexperienced may hinder the achievement of educational goals. However, if teachers are educated and qualified, it will aid effective realization of national consciousness sustainability. Also, managers must encourage effective planning of lesson and coordinate the curriculum and activities in relation to the level of maturity of the learners towards achieving stated educational objectives and national consciousness sustainability (situation). This study anchored on this theory of management such that, the realization of national consciousness sustainability depends largely on effective management of education by the school managers in terms of adequate and appropriate staffing, planning and coordination of school activities towards the achievement of predetermined educational goals.

METHODOLOGY

Research Design

Quantitative research design was used in this study. The designed was considered suitable because it helps the researchers to examine the connection that occurs between management of early childhood care education and national consciousness sustainability. It also assists by allowing the researchers to obtain the view of the sample population, using appropriate data analysis to analyze the collected data and reach a considerable conclusion about the population from the findings of the study (Dillman, et al, 2014).

Population and Sampling Techniques

This study focused on early childhood care education in North-east zone, Nigeria. There are 2,278 public early childhood care education and 3,782 teachers in North-east zone, Nigeria. The target population of this study comprised of 2,278 head teachers and 3,782 teachers in public early childhood care education in North-east zone zone, Nigeria as at the time of study. Sample of 331 head teachers and 351 teachers making a total of 682 participants were selected proportionally across the six States in North-east zone with the use of Research Advisor (2006) table of determining sample size of a known population with (confidence level =95%, Margin of Error = 5%) as shown in table 1. This involves obtaining the population of head teachers and teachers in each selected public early childhood care education in North-east zone, Nigeria. cluster sampling technique was used to select head teachers and teachers from the sample school in order to ensure that all categories of head teachers and teachers were given equal opportunity of being selected (Creswell, 2015). This implies that, all categories of head teachers and teachers were represented in this study.

Table 1: Population Sample of Head Teachers and Teachers of ECCE

S/N	North-west States	Number of ECCE schools	Selected head teachers	Number of ECCE. Teachers	Selected ECCE. Teachers
1	Adamawa	484	70	868	81
2	Bauchi	828	120	910	85
3	Borno	274	40	495	46
4	Gombe	319	47	802	74
5	Taraba	222	32	446	41
6	Yobe	151	22	261	24
Total		2,278	331	3,782	351

Source: National Personnel Audit Report (2019)

Instrumentation

A self-constructed questionnaire titled Managing Early Childhood Care Education Questionnaire (MECCEQ) and adapted questionnaire were used as the instrument for this study. A total of 17 items were used to measure managing early childhood care education with three sub-variables: staffing (5 items), planning of lesson (6 items) and coordination (6 items). The items of questionnaire regarding national consciousness sustainability were concluded from Abdullahi (2020) on good citizenship with (5 items) and tolerance with (5 items). Oguzie (2014) on peace and security with (5 items). Participants replied to four Likert scale point as follow: 4 = Strongly Agree (SA), 3 = Agree (A), 2 = Disagree (D) and 1 = Strongly Disagree (SD). The norm mean is given accordingly: $4 + 3 + 2 + 1 / 4 = 2.50$. the norm mean depicts that any item that is above or equal to the norm mean value of 2.50 is interpreted as agreed while the value below the norm mean value is disagreed by the participants (Allen & Christopher, 2007) conclude that 4-point Likert scale answer format was faster and easier to fill than 5 to 7-point scales answer format.

Validity and Reliability

Two experts in measurement and evaluation and two experts in educational management looked into the accurateness and correctness of the instrument so as to validate the instrument.

Based on their comments and recommendations, proper corrections and adjustment were made. Furthermore, 40 corrected copies were further administered to head teachers and teachers who are part of the sample to spot their clarity of the items of wording, scales and instructions of the questions in order to notice if there might be any challenges in filled the questionnaire. Therefore, some recommendations made were corrected properly before sending the final copies. The reliability of the instrument was done with the use of Cronbach's alpha as shown in Table 2.

Table 2: Reliability Test for MECCEQ and NCS

Variables	Sub-variables	N	Cronbach's alpha	Decision
Managing ECCE	Staffing	5	0.82	All items are suitable and reliable
	Planning	6	0.86	All items are suitable and reliable
	Coordination	6	0.82	All items are suitable and reliable
National consciousness sustainability	Good citizenship	5	0.80	All items are suitable and reliable
	Tolerance	5	0.84	All items are suitable and reliable
	Peace and security	5	0.82	All items are suitable and reliable

Table 2 shows the result of the reliability test for MECCEQ, these are staffing, planning and coordination. The Cronbach's alpha value for staffing is 0.82 covering up to 5 items, 0.86 for planning of lesson with 6 items and 0.82 for coordination with 6 items. Also, on national consciousness sustainability variables, the Cronbach's alpha value for sub-variables is 0.80 for good citizenship, 0.84 for tolerance and 0.82 for peace and security. Values above 0.70 are considered suitable and reliable (Gay, et al, 2009; Ary, et al, 2010).

Data Collection Procedure

The participants were communicated in their respective offices to discuss the motive for the study before the distribution of the questionnaire. The researchers with the support of two research assistants personally administered the questionnaire to the head teachers and teachers of the sample public early childhood care education. Appropriate administering of questionnaires was also aided with the cooperation of colleagues and friends in the sample schools. The questionnaires were administered to over 700 participants consisting of the selected head teachers and teachers in public early childhood care education. After 2 weeks, all the filled questionnaires were recovered from the participants. However, a total of 684 questionnaires were returned and filled properly. Therefore, the returned number meets the suggestion of Research Advisor (2006) with a number of 682 participants sample in this study. In the guideline provided by (Johnson & Christensen, 2008; Hesse-Biber & Leavy, 2011;), this study emphasized on ethical issues in guaranteeing secrecy and privacy of participants responses by providing consent column box which indicates willingness to participate and not willing to participate.

Data Analysis

The data gathered for the study were analyzed using Statistical Packages for Social Science (SPSS, version 22). Descriptive statistics like mean and standard deviation to address the research objectives of the study. Inferential statistics such as Pearson product moment correlation and linear multiple regression statistical analysis was used to test the hypotheses at (0.05) significance level to determine the acceptable or rejection of the hypotheses.

FINDINGS

This part discusses the result of the findings based on research objectives.

Staffing

Objective 1: Examine the relationship between staffing and national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria.

Table 3 reveals the analysis of the participants responses for the construct of staffing and national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria.

Table 3. Mean and Standard Deviation on Staffing as Responded by Participants

S/N	Staffing	Participants Responses		Decision
		Mean	SD	
1	Quality staff improve effective development of human capital towards promoting national consciousness sustainability.	2.88	1.002	Agreed
2	Staffing helps in building higher morale by providing right climate for learners to contribute positively to the development of an organisation.	2.96	0.910	Agreed
3	Helps to improve the quality in the learners that will promote national development.	2.78	1.032	Agreed
4	Facilitates growth and diversification of country economy through recognition of different skill and knowledge.	2.91	0.959	Agreed
5	Acquiring and deploying of quality workers create positive impact on organization's effectiveness.	2.93	0.964	Agreed
	Overall Mean	2.89	0.973	

Table 3 revealed the overall perception of participants on staffing is interpreted as "Agreed" ($M = 2.89$, $SD = 0.973$). This reveals that participants agreed that staffing improves national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. In addition, all responses obtained mean values higher than the norm mean value of 2.50. This shows that participants agreed that staffing i) improve effective development of human capital towards promoting national consciousness sustainability ($M = 2.88$, $SD = 1.002$), ii) helps in building higher morale by providing right climate for learners to contribute positively to the development of an organisation ($M = 2.96$, $SD = 0.910$), iii) helps to improve the quality in the learners that will promote national development ($M = 2.78$, $SD = 1.032$), iv) facilitates growth and diversification of country economy through recognition of different skill and knowledge ($M = 2.91$, $SD = 0.959$), v) create positive impact on organization's effectiveness ($M = 2.93$, $SD = 0.964$),

Planning of lesson

Objective 2: Investigate the relationship between planning of lesson and national consciousness sustainability in North- east, Nigeria.

Table 4 shows the mean and standard deviation responses of headteachers and teachers on planning of lesson.

Table 4. Mean and Standard Deviation of Items on planning of Lesson

S/N	Planning of Lesson	Participants Responses		Decision
		Mean	SD	
1.	Teacher planning of lesson encourages learners' creativity and innovation	2.82	0.994	Agreed
2.	Planning aids in organizing all available instructional materials towards achieving effective teaching and learning.	2.97	0.977	Agreed
3.	Planning of lesson helps in creating a threat-free environment for growth and development.	2.94	0.974	Agreed
4.	Planning leads to better use of time which is a valuable asset to achieve educational goals.	2.96	0.967	Agreed
5.	Effective planning of lesson motivates learners to learn.	2.85	1.016	Agreed
6.	Builds collaborative processes between teachers and learners	2.99	0.924	Agreed
	Overall Mean	2.92	0.975	

The overall perception of the participants on planning of lesson as shown in table 4 is interpreted as "Agreed" ($M = 2.92$, $SD = 0.975$). This reveals that participants agreed that planning of lesson enhance national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. Also, all the responses obtained mean values higher than the norm mean value of 2.50. This shows that participants agreed that planning of lesson i) encourages learners' creativity and innovation ($M = 2.82$, $SD = 0.994$), ii) aids in organizing all available instructional materials towards achieving effective teaching and learning ($M = 2.97$, $SD = 0.977$), iii) helps in creating a threat-free environment for growth and development ($M = 2.94$, $SD = 0.974$), iv) leads to better use of time which is a valuable asset to achieve educational goals ($M = 2.96$, $SD = 0.967$), v) motivates learners to learn ($M = 2.85$, $SD = 1.016$), vi) builds collaborative processes between teachers and school managers ($M = 2.99$, $SD = 0.968$).

Table 5: Mean and Standard Deviation on Coordination as Responded by Participants

S/N	Coordinating	Participants Responses		Decision
		Mean	SD	
1.	Ensures mutual understanding and effective teamwork for realization of national consciousness sustainability.	2.90	0.985	Agreed
2.	Improves high standard of discipline among learners at school and at home.	3.02	0.986	Agreed
3.	Assists school authority provide adequate security for life and property in school.	2.91	0.968	Agreed
4.	Makes the community member aware of their responsibility to the children, community and nation at large.	2.90	0.964	Agreed
5.	Helps to impact in learners appropriate moral, traditions, customs and social life of the community.	2.92	0.956	Agreed
6.	Makes learners to have knowledge of the environment the live by encouraging the study of important and relevant aspect of the community life.	2.92	0.922	
	Overall Mean	2.93	0.964	

The overall perception of the participants on coordination as shown in table 5 is interpreted as “Agreed” ($M = 2.93$, $SD = 0.964$). This reveals that participants agreed that coordination bring about national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. Also, all the responses obtained mean values higher than the norm mean value of 2.50. This shows that participants agreed that coordination i) ensures mutual understanding and effective teamwork for realization of national consciousness sustainability ($M = 2.90$, $SD = 0.985$), ii) improves high standard of discipline among learners at school and at home ($M = 3.02$, $SD = 0.926$), iii) assists school authority provide adequate security for life and property in school ($M = 2.91$, $SD = 0.968$), iv) makes the community member aware of their responsibility to the children, community and nation at large ($M = 2.90$, $SD = 0.964$), v) helps to impact in learners appropriate moral, traditions, customs and social life of the community ($M = 2.92$, $SD = 0.956$), vi) Makes learners to have knowledge of the environment the live by encouraging the study of important and relevant aspect of the community life ($M = 2.87$, $SD = 0.922$).

Hypotheses Testing

Pearson product moment correlation coefficient statistic was used in this study to test the set hypotheses as follow:

H_{a1} : there is a significant relationship between staffing and national consciousness sustainability

Table 6: Correlational Analysis for Staffing and National consciousness sustainability

		Staffing	National consciousness sustainability
Staffing	Pearson	1	.870**
	Correlation		
	Sig. (2-Tailed)		.000
	N	681	681
National consciousness sustainability	Pearson	.870**	1
	Correlation		
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.000	
	N	681	681

Table 6 reveals that staffing has a significant and positive relationship with national consciousness sustainability with calculated r-value = .870; $p < .000$. This shows that there is a significant relationship between staffing and national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. Therefore, the extremely significant $p < 0.01$ correlation indicate a high level of relationship and supported, which implies high level of confidence in the link (Cresswell, 2015). H_{a2} : there is a significant relationship between planning of lesson and national consciousness sustainability.

Table 7. Correlational Analysis for Planning of Lesson and National consciousness sustainability

		Planning of lesson	National consciousness sustainability
Planning of lesson	Pearson	1	.910
	Correlation		
	Sig. (2-Tailed)		.000
	N	681	681
National consciousness sustainability	Pearson	.910	1
	Correlation		
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.000	
	N	681	681

Table 7 shows that planning of lesson has a significant and positive relationship with national consciousness sustainability with calculated r-value = .910; $p < .000$. This reveals that there is a significant relationship between planning of lesson and national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. Thus, the hypothesis which state that there is a significant relationship between planning of lesson and national consciousness sustainability is accepted with significant $p < 0.01$, which implies high level of confidence in the correlation (Padilla-Diaz, 2015).

Table 8. Correlational Analysis for Coordination and National consciousness sustainability

		Coordination	National consciousness sustainability
Coordination	Pearson	1	.890
	Correlation		
	Sig. (2-Tailed)		.000
	N	681	681
National consciousness sustainability	Pearson	.890	1
	Correlation		
	Sig. (2-tailed)	.000	
	N	681	681

Table 8 reveals that coordination has a significant and positive relationship with national consciousness sustainability with calculated r-value = .890; $p < .000$. This reveals that there is a significant relationship between coordination and national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. Thus, the extremely significant $p < 0.01$ correlation indicate a high level of relationship and supported, which implies high level of confidence in the relationship (Gay et al, 2009).

Linear Regression Analysis

Objective 3: To find out the relationship among staffing, planning of lesson, coordination and national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria.

This presents the linear regression finding on the relationship between management of early childhood care education and national consciousness sustainability.

Table 9. Linear Regression of Management of Early Childhood Care Education and National consciousness sustainability

Model	R	R Square	Adjusted R Square	Std. Error of the Estimate
1	0.118	0.918	0.901	0.652

a. Predictors: (constant), Staffing, Planning of lesson and Coordination

Table 9 shows that management of early childhood care education has significant effect on national consciousness sustainability with .901 of R square value from the table. Thus, the result revealed that management of early childhood care education may possibly have positive impact on national consciousness sustainability (Creswell & Creswell (2017).

Table 10. Linear Regression Coefficient for Management of Early Childhood Care Education and National consciousness sustainability

Model	Unstandardize d coefficients		Standardized coefficients	T	Sig.
	B	Std. Error	Beta		
(Constant)	0.994	0.324	0.506	6.432	0.000
Staffing	0.413	0.256	0.404	1.546	0.920
Planning of lesson	0.996	0.216	0.448	0.876	0.966
Coordination	0.158	0.244	0.136	0.808	0.910

a. Dependent Variable: national consciousness sustainability

According to Table 10, the standard regression weight of the beta coefficients value for management of early childhood care education was 0.994 which shows that improve in management of early childhood care education enhance national consciousness sustainability. Also, revealed that management of early childhood care education and national consciousness sustainability were indisputably related. T-test of 6.432 was sufficiently high with corresponding p-value of 0.000. Therefore, in comparison, planning of lesson has the highest impact (Beta=0.996), staffing (Beta = 413) and coordination (Beta= 0.158). In summary, there is significant and perfect relationship between management of early childhood care education in terms of staffing, planning of lesson, coordination and national consciousness sustainability (Patton, 2002).

DISCUSSION

The findings in table 3 show that staffing enhances national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. such that, it improve effective development of human capital towards promoting national consciousness sustainability, help in building higher morale by providing right climate for learners to contribute positively to the development of an organisation, improve the quality the learners that will promote national development, facilitate growth and diversification of country economy through recognition of different skill and knowledge as well as create positive impact on organization's effectiveness. Results from hypothesis one showed that there is positive relationship between staffing and national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. This finding concurs with Alexopoulos (2019) that staffing brings about organisational goals to fruition. This finding agreed with Onah (2008) that staffing is the key to rapid and efficient service delivery and organisational goals. Also, this finding is germane to Nwaka and Ofojele (2010) that staffing is the critical resource for the implementation and realization of stated educational goals and objectives. This finding is in line with strong (2018) that staffing contributes immensely to the enhancement and improvement of student academic performance and emotional maturity.

The findings in table 4 reveal that planning of lesson enhance national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. Such that, it encourages learners' creativity and innovation, aids in organizing all available instructional materials towards achieving effective teaching and learning, helps in creating a threat-free environment for growth and development, leads to better use of time, which is a valuable asset to achieve educational goals, motivates learners to learn as well as builds collaborative processes between teachers and school managers. Results from hypothesis two shows that there is significant relationship between planning of lesson and national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. This finding agrees with William and Aniefiok (2014); Abdullahi, (2016) that planning of lesson logically enhance effective national development. This finding concurs with Quah (2011) that planning of lesson enhance effective delivery of instruction.

The findings in table 5 reveal that coordination improve national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. Such that, it ensures mutual understanding and effective teamwork for realization of national consciousness sustainability, improves high standard of discipline among learners at school and at home, assists school authority provide adequate security for life and property in school, makes the community member aware of their responsibility to the children, community and nation at large, helps to impact in learners appropriate moral, traditions, customs and social life of the community as well as makes learners to have knowledge of the environment the live by encouraging the study of important and relevant aspect of the community life. Results from hypothesis two shows that there is significant relationship between coordination and national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. This finding agrees with Abdulkareem and Sheu (2014) that coordination promotes instructional performance and effectiveness of teachers towards the attainment of educational goals. Also, this finding concurs with Muhammad et al (2011) that instructional coordination helps student to develop appropriate skills and aids effective management of classroom.

Regression analysis finding revealed that there is positive relationship between management of early childhood care education and national consciousness sustainability in North-east zone, Nigeria. This finding agrees with Mustafa et al (2018) that basic education play an important role in promoting national consciousness. Also, this finding conforms to Willy (2013) that learners play an important pivotal role in shaping national identify and national consciousness. This finding agrees with Oguzie (2014) that understanding of national consciousness promote peace and security in the country. This finding disagreed with Oppong (2019); Al-Khalas and Abu-Helo (2013) that kindergarten curricula do not promote patriotism among learners.

RECOMMENDATIONS

School managers should continue to provide appropriate and adequate staffing of early childhood care education so as to improve effective development of human capital towards promoting national consciousness sustainability, help in building higher morale by providing right climate for learners to contribute positively to the development of an organisation, improve the quality the learners that will promote national development, facilitate growth and diversification of country economy through recognition of different skill and knowledge as well as create positive impact on organization's effectiveness toward achieving national consciousness sustainability. Also, school managers encourage care givers to effectively plan lessons and other activities of early childhood care education in order to encourage learners' creativity and innovation, aid in organizing all available instructional materials towards achieving effective teaching and learning, help in creating a threat-free environment for growth and development of learners, make better use of time which is a valuable asset to achieve educational goals, motivate learners to learn as well as build collaborative processes between caregivers/teachers and school managers towards the realization of national consciousness sustainability. Furthermore, school managers should continue to coordinate early childhood care education effectively and efficiently so as to ensure mutual understanding and effective teamwork for realization of national consciousness sustainability, improve high standard of discipline among learners at school and at home, provide adequate security for life and property in school, make the community member aware of their responsibility to the children,

community and nation at large, help to impact in learners appropriate moral, traditions, customs and social life of the community as well as make learners to have knowledge of the environment they live by encouraging the study of important and relevant aspect of the community life.

IMPLICATION AND CONCLUSION

The findings of this study will help the government and principals to adequately display effective leadership behaviour that will bring about appropriate curriculum coordination and evaluation of instruction. Also, this finding will be of benefit to teachers in selecting appropriate textbooks and learning so as to enhance national consciousness sustainability. Furthermore, this finding would serve as a reference point for future researchers in the field of education.

Management of early childhood care education is an importance measure for achieving national consciousness sustainability. Based on the findings of this study, the researcher concluded that there was positive and significant relationship between the three indices of management of early childhood care education (staffing, planning of lesson & coordination) and national consciousness sustainability as they were found to be connected with one another.

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